

The Noble One Who Liberates from the Eight Great Fears: A Dhāraṇī

Ārya-aṣṭa-mahābhaya-tāriṇī-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 541 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་འཇམ་མཉམ་པ་ཆེན་པོ་བོད་ལྗང་ལམ་སྒྲོ་བ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའུ་གི་བྱུང་སྐུ་

Toh 541 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-aṣṭa-mahābhaya-tāriṇī-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Jikpa Chenpo Gyé Lé Drolwa Zhejawa'i Zung, meaning "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the One Who Liberates from the Eight Great Fears." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on the bodhisattva Tārā in her aspect as a protector who delivers beings from eight categories of great fear. The text opens with homages to a series of tathāgatas and to the great compassionate bodhisattva who grants fearlessness, before presenting the dhāraṇī formula itself, which practitioners would recite for protection and liberation from danger. As a dhāraṇī, it is a relatively concise ritual and devotional text, representing the widespread Buddhist tradition of invoking Tārā's saving power through sacred speech.

In the language of India: Ārya-aṣṭa-mahābhaya-tāriṇī-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: the dhāraṇī called "The Noble One Who Liberates from the Eight Great Fears."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas. Homage to the Tathāgata, Source of Qualities. Homage to the Tathāgata, Fragrant with All-Pervading Incense. Homage to the Tathāgata, Endowed with Skill Unvanquished by Others. Homage to the Tathāgata, Dispeller of All Obscurations. Homage to the Tathāgata, Supreme Moon. Homage to the Tathāgata, King of Peace. Homage to the Tathāgata, Guru of the Moon. Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being endowed with great compassion, who renders all free from fear.

The mantra is as follows: dhare dhare, dhāre dhāraṇī, rana-koṭe abhayā-kalpe, kalpe nigaṇi, ananta-kalpe, amṛta-kalpe, hutāśare, ananta-mukhe, ananta-cakṣu-samudgate, oṃ bha svāhā.

Noble son, these dhāraṇī mantras were spoken, blessed, and rejoiced in by buddhas, Blessed Ones, as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, for the sake of sentient beings who would go to the lower realms.

Noble son, whatever bodhisattva holds this dhāraṇī shall utterly transcend the eight fears in their boundless measure: the boundless fear of the hells, the boundless fear of birth in the animal realm, the boundless fear of the realm of

Yama, lord of death, the boundless fear of hungry ghosts, the boundless fear of treacherous paths, the boundless fear of birth, the boundless fear of illness, and the boundless fear of death. The buddhas and Blessed Ones of the ten directions will turn their minds toward that person. At the time of death one's mind will remain undistracted, and one will be born in the presence of the buddhas. One will obtain a body of inexhaustible nature.

Translator's Notes

- The seven Tathāgata epithets — Source of Qualities, Fragrant with All-Pervading Incense, and so forth — are standard names drawn from the canonical Seven Medicine Buddha or related devotional traditions. They are rendered here in their conventional sense.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear; the reconstructed Sanskrit is approximate, as dhāraṇī mantras of this type often resist clean syntactic parsing.

The phrase rendered "treacherous paths" translates a term literally meaning "difficult to traverse" or "perilous roads," which in this context refers to dangerous wilderness or inaccessible terrain as one of the eight conventional external fears that Tārā is said to protect against.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.